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Section Title(S)

The Homonymous Method of Applying Kin Terms to Consanguineous Kin and Affines

Some of ego's secondary affines would be named for his primary affines and some, possibly, for his offspring. These children would be ego's secondary affines, and ego would apply generational terms to them which correspond in joking status to the term he applies to the person for whom they were named.

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The correspondence of the affinal terms with the generational terms is shown in Table 14.^A

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Diagrams will be given to illustrate the homonymous method of applying terms, but they do not illustrate a typical family. No Bushman family we knew in 1952–53 had as many living children as in Figure 7, to say nothing of Figure 11. ≠Toma, helping me one day to construct one of these hypothetical illustrations, laughed and said, “Who is this who has so many children? Is it an ostrich?”

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In the figure, letters represent names. A person who is designated by the same letter as a person in a generation above him has been named for that person. The naming in the diagrams is customary. Children are named most often for their grandparents, the siblings of their parents, and the spouses of those siblings.

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Figures 5 and 6^B illustrate the application of terms between ego's *!gun!a* and ego, and between members of the *!gun!a*'s family and ego. All ego's kin in these two diagrams are assumed to be older than ego, and they, as the older persons, establish the terms they use for ego according to their homonymous pattern. They would apply the diminutives, and what we see in the diagrams is ego's reciprocation with the form of the term appropriate to the older persons.

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In Figure 5, ego is named for his FaFa, C. His FaFa and FaMo term ego *!guma*. He reciprocates calling them *!gun!a* and *tūn*. A and B, siblings of C, term ego *tsĩ*, younger sibling, because he is named for their sibling; ego reciprocates giving them the sibling terms. E and F term ego *tsuma* because he is named for their father; ego calls them *tsu* and *// ga*.

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In Figure 6, ego is named for his FaBr, D. Ego's grandparents term [p.231]

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Personal Names

TABLE 14. Correspondence between Affinal Terms and the Generational Terms Used for Ego's Kin Named for Affines

Affine for Whom Kin Is Named	Applied to Males		Affine for Whom Kin Is Named	Applied to Females	
	Term Ego Applies to Kinsman Named for Affine	Joking		Term Ego Applies to Kinsman Named for Affine	Joking
!hoa	!gun!a w.s. or tūn!ga w.s.	yes yes	tsau	tūn	yes
n!unba	!gun!a m.s., w.s. or tūn!ga w.s.	yes yes	n!untai	tūn	yes
≠tum	tsu	no	/utsu	//ga	no
tūn!ga m.s.	tsu m.s.	no	tūn	tūn	yes
tūn!ga w.s.	!gun!a w.s. or tūn!ga w.s.	yes yes			
!go or tsĩ	!go or tsĩ	yes m.s. no w.s.	!kwi or tsĩ	!kwi or tsĩ	no m.s. yes m.s.

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Kin Relationships

PAGE 232 IS BLANK233 applying to persons descending from his *!gun!a*'s nuclear family the same terms that he applied to the persons for whom they were named. Figure 7, which shows terms applied to cousins, illustrates this point.

A, [For Table 14, see Category 601, p. 231—Analyst]

B, [For Figs. 5 & 6, see Category 601, p. 232—Analyst]

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